

Revitalized Cat Nine Tops UTEP

WAC Series Continues At Arizona Diamond

By GEORGE ORTON
Star Staff Writer

A "revitalized" Arizona baseball team began its climb back to Western Athletic Conference contention with a 12-5 win over the University of Texas at El Paso yesterday on the UA field.

It was the first conference win for the Cats after four straight losses, including one in the third game of the series at El Paso, and a three game sweep by the University of New Mexico last weekend.

The Wildcats, publicly criticized for their behavior in the El Paso airport following the Saturday doubleheader, held a meeting before yesterday's game.

After the game a club spokesman said there had been a previous meeting Monday.

"The meeting today was to go over things we talked about Monday."

"The whole thing came to a head after the New Mexico series. We played poorly last week and we decided if we wanted to go anywhere we would have to play better."

"There were things we felt we had to talk out among ourselves. The incident in El Paso had nothing to do with it. We don't feel that caused us to lose to New Mexico. We simply played poorly."

Arizona continues the series with UTEP today with a double header beginning at 1 p.m. on the UA field. Larry Dierks of Arizona will face UTEP's Harry Milner.

Leon Hooten went the distance for the Cats to pick up his eighth win of the season against three losses. The tall right hander also picked up three hits, including a triple, and scored four times.

The Cats jumped to a 1-0 lead in the first inning, and after UTEP had tied the game in the third on a booming home run by Miner pitcher Mark Bombard, scored in the bottom of the third on Hooten's triple and Mark Driscoll's sacrifice fly.

The Cats put together back to back four run innings in the fifth and sixth innings to put the game out of reach.

An error by UTEP shortstop Rick Butler opened the gates in the fifth and the Cats pounded out five hits to score the four runs.

In the sixth, with the bases loaded, J. Ray Rokey drilled a fly ball to right field, and Butler, who had moved to right from shortstop, misplayed the ball for his second error and before the inning had ended the Cats had four more runs.

The Cats tucked the game away in the seventh with two more runs on another UTEP error, this time by first baseman John Miller and three straight singles by Driscoll, Tim Gump and Rod O'Brien.

UTEP	ab	r	h	bi	Arizona	ab	r	h	bi
Sandoval, 2B	3	0	0	0	Driscoll, 2B	4	2	2	2
Molberg, 3B	3	0	1	0	Gump, 1B	4	2	2	2
Miller, 1B	3	0	1	0	O'Brien, 1B	4	2	2	2
Prokopenko, IF	3	2	1	0	Middle, RF	4	1	4	2
Harper, CF	4	0	2	2	Rokey, C	4	0	0	0
Butler, SS	3	0	2	2	Jacome, RF	4	0	1	1
Shimo, RF	2	0	0	0	Williams, 3B	4	0	0	0
Baker, PH	2	0	0	0	Frost, C	4	0	0	0
Pedro, C	4	0	1	0	Hooten, P	4	4	3	0
Bombard, P	1	1	1	1					
Dieselhorst, P	1	0	0	0					
Milner, 2B	0	0	0	0					
Hernandez, PR	0	0	0	0					

Totals 34 5 11 5 Totals 40 12 15 9

UTEP	001	002	000	—	5	11	4
Arizona	101	404	302	—	12	15	9
E — Miller (2), Butler (2), Jacome, LOS — UTEP J. Arizona 8, 2B — Sandoval, Harper, Butler, Middle, Gump, O'Brien, Driscoll, 3B — Hooten, RF — Bombard, 5B — Butler, Hooten, 1B — Bombard, 2B — Butler, Driscoll.							
Bombard (L, 4-4) 2-3	12	10	8	8	8	8	8
Dieselhorst 2-3	11	2	2	2	2	2	2
Hooten (W, 4-3) 2-3	11	2	2	2	2	2	2
WP — Bombard (2), PB — Rokey, U — Acuna and Chap							